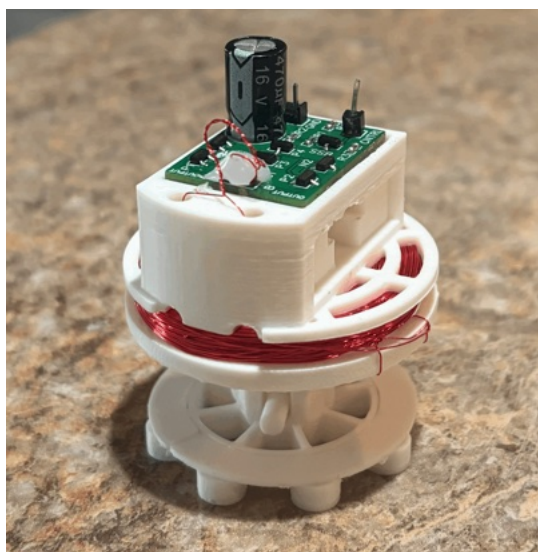




Metal Orchestra Toggle Actuator

ARAM-MOTCA_0_10-0SP*

Quick Start Guide



Product of American Robotics Assisted Manufacturing

www.ARAM-USA.com

View further kit usage information & legal information



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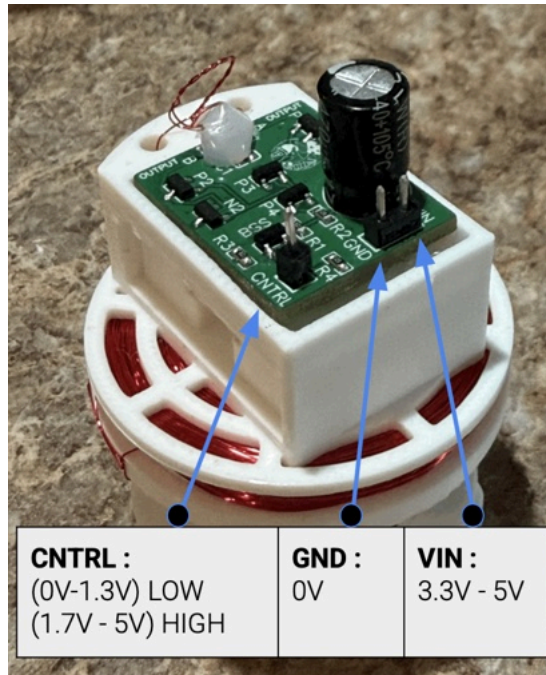
Introduction

Thanks for using ARAM's Metal Orchestra Kit. In here you'll find everything you need to get started. Including simple usage with buttons, breadboards, and microcontrollers, (ESP32/Arduino). Use this actuator with household metal items to create an orchestra. In the companion "Metal Orchestra Quick Start Guide" view details on using these actuators to create a bluetooth MIDI instrument

*Please read the full spec sheet and view legal disclaimers.



Pinout and Basic Usage



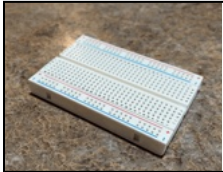
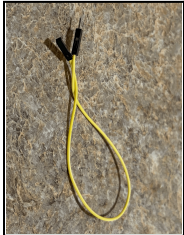
Pin	Voltage	Additional Comments
VIN	3.3V to 5V Continuous 5V+ to 12V Pulsed	Incorrectly plugging VIN to 0V may damage your unit
GND	0V	Incorrectly plugging GND to voltage may damage your unit
CNTRL	(0V - 1.3V) Low (1.7V - 5V) High	(Default) Pulldown to 0V <i>High Signal</i> will cause strike <i>Low Signal</i> will cause retract



Using With A Breadboard: Basic Operation

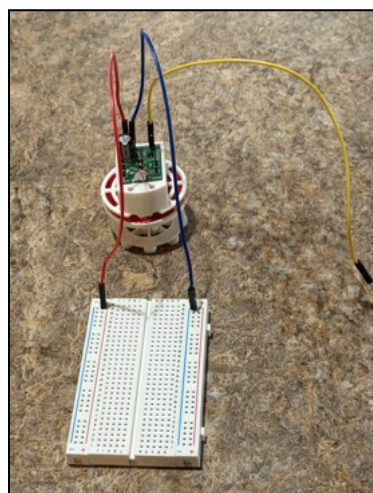
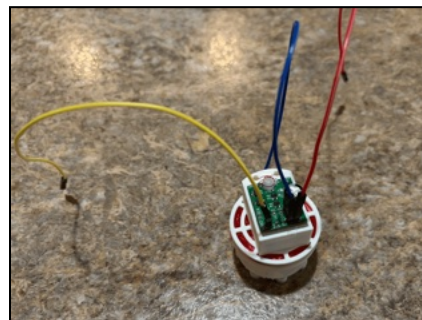
Lets confirm the basic operation of your actuator:

You'll need:

				
1 x Power Supply 3.3V - 5V <i>capable of 0.5 Amps</i>	1 x Solderless Breadboard	3 x Male to Male Jumper Wire	3 x Male to Female Jumper Wire	1 x ARAM-MOTCA Toggle Actuator

First let's attach jumpers to the actuator:

- Plug red/white lead into VIN
- Plug blue/black lead into GND
- Plug the remaining color lead into CNTRL



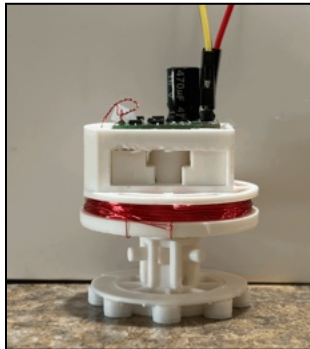
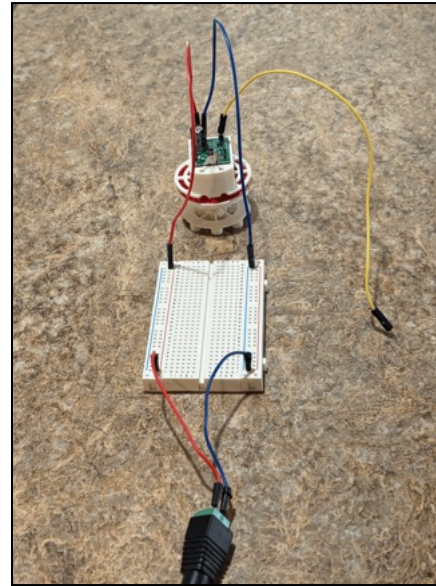
Now plug the actuator into the breadboard

- Plug the red/white lead into the rail labeled (+) as shown in the image.
- Plug the blue/black lead into the rail labeled (-) as shown in the image.



Next we connect the power supply:

- Connect positive (+) from the power supply to the positive (+) rail of the breadboard
- Connect negative (-) from the power supply to the negative rail of the breadboard
- ***Before plugging the power supply in: Double check all connections are correct***



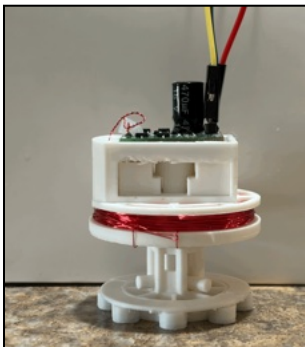
Your actuator is ready to use!

The actuator has two states:

Strike
Retract

To make the actuator strike, grab that last wire, the CNTRL lead.

- If you plug this lead into (-) the actuator will **retract**
- If you plug this lead into (+) the actuator will **strike**



The CNTRL pin will automatically go to 0V (ie: the negative rail voltage) if you forget to plug it into anything.

Therefore the default behavior for the actuator is to be in the retract position.



Using With A Breadboard: Basic Operation With Buttons

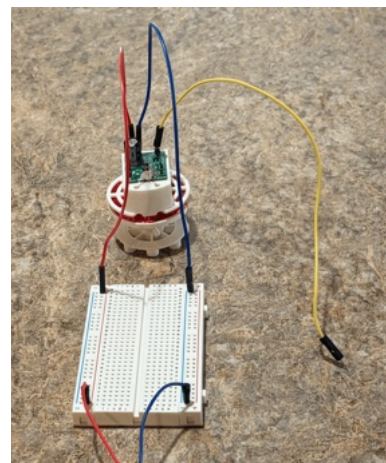
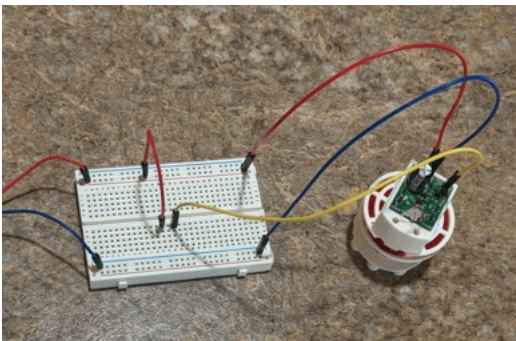
Let's make a basic button control board for your actuator:

You'll need:

					
1 x Power Supply 3.3V - 5V <i>capable of 0.5 Amps</i>	1 x Solderless Breadboard	4 x Male to Male Jumper Wire	3 x Male to Female Jumper Wire	1 x ARAM-MOTCA Toggle Actuator	1 x Push Button

First wire VIN and GND to the breadboard, along with the power supply like in the previous page.

- Don't power the supply on yet



Now build your button circuit

- Using a jumper connect the positive (+) rail to any rail in the middle of the breadboard

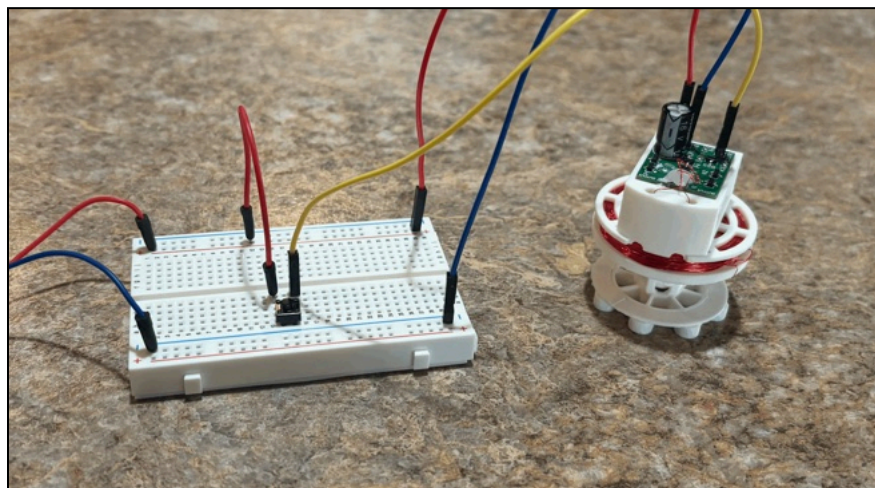


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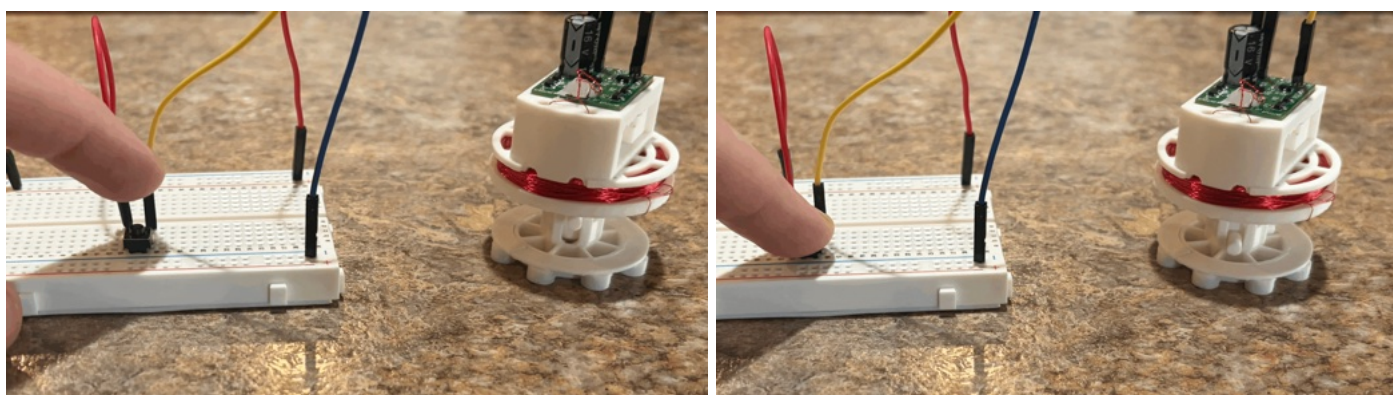
- Connect the CNTRL wire two rails away as shown in the image

Now place a button on the breadboard bridging the two rails.
This completes the button circuit

Always double check your connections before plugging in your power supply



Simply press the button the strike, and release the button to retract





Using With An ESP32/Arduino: Basic Operation

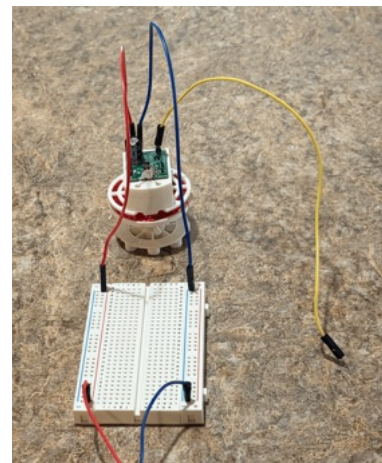
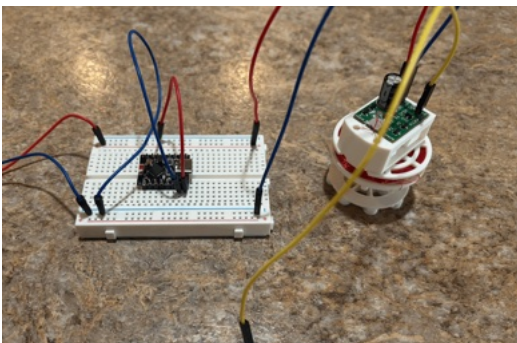
This is the basic wiring for all of the ESP32/Arduino Projects shown here

You'll need:

					
1 x Power Supply 3.3V - 5V capable of 0.5 Amps	1 x Solderless Breadboard	4 x Male to Male Jumper Wire	3 x Male to Female Jumper Wire	1 x ARAM-MOTCA Toggle Actuator	1 x Push Button

First wire VIN and GND to the breadboard, along with the power supply like in “Using With A Breadboard: Basic Operation”

- Don't power the supply on yet



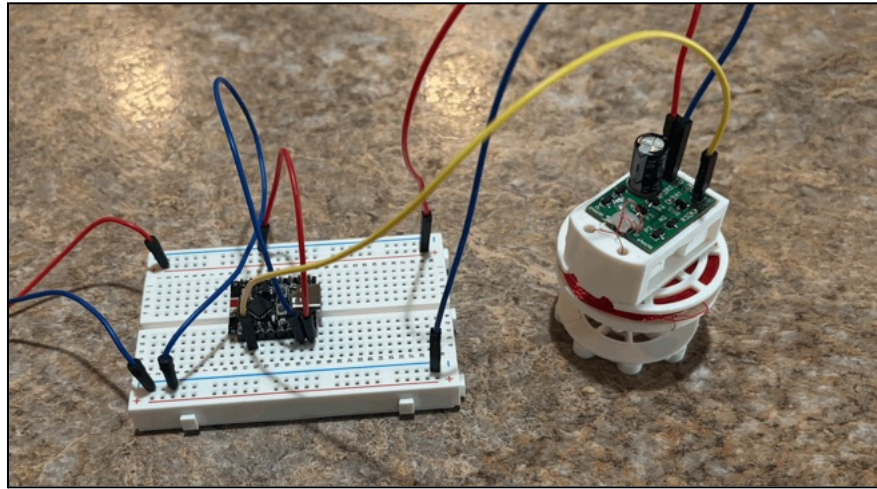
Now place the ESP32/Arduino In the middle of the breadboard

- Using a jumper connect the positive rail of the breadboard (+), to either VIN (if using 3.3V power supply) or to the 5V pin (If using a 5V power supply).
- Using a jumper connect the negative rail of the breadboard (-), to the GND pin



Now simply connect the CNTRL pin of the actuator to whichever pin of your ESP32/Arduino which you want to control the actuator

Always double check your connections before plugging in your power supply



Now the ESP32/Arduino is ready to use the actuator.

You may strike the actuator by calling:
`pinWrite(cntrl_pin, HIGH)`

You may retract the actuator by calling:
`pinWrite(cntrl_pin, LOW)`

However the next section covers the implementation of the ARAM_TOGGLE_ACTUATOR library which streamlines the use of these, without needing to call `pinWrite` directly.



Using With An ESP32/Arduino: Actuator Library

For ease of use ARAM has released a library compatible with our toggle actuators.

To use the library simply type “ARAM_Toggle_Actuator” into the Arduino IDE library manager, and select the entry by that name.

Getting Started

To import the library into your code use:

```
#include "ARAM_TOGGLE_ACTUATOR.h"
```

To declare a new actuator use:

```
ARAM_TOGGLE_ACTUATOR myActuator;
```

To initialize the actuator use

```
myActuator = ARAM_TOGGLE_ACTUATOR( Cntrl_pin );
```

Or if you intend to use it with the instrument library you must also declare a frequency.

```
myActuator = ARAM_TOGGLE_ACTUATOR( Cntrl_pin , frequency_in_hertz );
```

(To precisely determine the frequency simply use an audio analyzer app to determine which frequency is loudest when the actuator strikes its target)

Basic Operation

Use the following to make the actuator strike/retract

```
myActuator.strike();  
myActuator.retract();
```

Tune the actuator to the specific resonator attached using

```
myActuator.setFrequencyTuning( MinFrequency, MaxFrequency, DampingAmount)
```

See [Tuning and Troubleshooting](#) for more information on this



Advanced Operation : Update

To use beat, vibrate, or schedule functionality, you must call the following function inside the loop:

```
myActuator.update();
```

Advanced Operation : Beats

You can cause the actuator to generate a beat using

```
myActuator.generateBeat(strike_time, beat_timing);
```

Here strike_time is the amount of time the actuator should be striking for, in milliseconds

Here beat_timing is the amount of time between beats, in milliseconds

generateBeat(100,1000) -> generates a strike for 100ms every 1 second

Stop the beat using

```
myActuator.stopBeat();
```

Advanced Operation : Vibration

You can cause the actuator to vibrate a specific frequency using

```
myActuator.vibrateAt(frequency);
```

You can stop the vibration using

```
myActuator.endMovement();
```

Advanced Operation : Actuator Modes

Putting the actuator into standard actuator mode lets you use all functionality, also the actuator always ends in the retract position

```
myActuator.setActuatorMode( ARAM_TOGGLE_ACTUATOR_Actuator );
```

Putting the actuator into frequency generator mode restrict you to vibrate functionality, also the actuator always ends in the strike position

```
myActuator.setActuatorMode( ARAM_TOGGLE_ACTUATOR_Frequency_Generator );
```



Using With An ESP32/Arduino: Actuator Library - Using the Actuator

As described in the earlier section, using the actuator with the ARAM_Toggle_Actuator library is incredibly easy. This example code shows declaring an actuator, and then causing it to strike and retract in a repeating motion.

```
//import ARAM Toggle Actuator Library
#include "ARAM_Toggle_Actuator.h";

//define what pin we're gonna use
#define CNTRL_PIN_A 1 //change me to your desired cntrl pin A

//declare toggle actuator
ARAM_TOGGLE_ACTUATOR a1;

void setup() {

  //explicitly set pin to output mode <- may not be necessary
  gpio_reset_pin(GPIO_NUM_1);

  //initialize toggle actuator
  a1 = ARAM_TOGGLE_ACTUATOR(CNTRL_PIN_A);
}

void loop() {

  //make the actuator strike
  a1.strike();

  //wait 75 ms
  delay(75);

  //retract actuator
  a1.retract();

  //wait 75 ms
  delay(75);
}
```



Using With An ESP32/Arduino: Actuator Library - Generating A Beat

This example code shows declaring an actuator, and then causing it to generate a beat. Notice how `update()` is called in the loop function.

```
//import ARAM Toggle Actuator Library
#include "ARAM_Toggle_Actuator.h";

//define what pin we're gonna use
#define CNTRL_PIN_A 1 //change me to your desired cntrl pin A

//declare toggle actuator
ARAM_TOGGLE_ACTUATOR a1;

void setup() {
  //explicitly set pin to output mode <- may not be necessary
  gpio_reset_pin(GPIO_NUM_1);

  //initialize toggle actuator
  a1 = ARAM_TOGGLE_ACTUATOR(CNTRL_PIN_A);

  //have the actuator generate a beat
  a1.generateBeat(100, 500);
}

void loop() {
  //in the loop we must call update on each actuator in order to use the beat functionality
  a1.update();
}
```



Further Uses: Instrument Library, and Bluetooth MIDI Instrument

Bluetooth MIDI Instrument :

Once you've familiarized yourself with the actuator, you can take it to the next level by creating a Bluetooth MIDI instrument. Follow the guide in the companion guide, "Metal Orchestra Quick Start Guide", to see how this is done.

Instrument Library:

This library is general purpose to turn an array of actuators into a playable instrument. This is what we use for our Bluetooth MIDI Instrument, but it can be used for any other project too. View the companion guide, "Metal Orchestra Quick Start Guide", to see how this is used.

Additional Resources:

<https://github.com/ARAM-USA-Support/ARAM-Metal-Orchestra>

(Metal Orchestra Github Documentation Mirror)

https://github.com/ARAM-USA-Support/ARAM-MOTCA_0_10-0S

(MOTCA-1 Toggle Actuator Github Documentation Mirror)

*All documentation is also available at www.ARAM-USA.com

For all projects, guides, documents, and questions please:

View Our Website : www.ARAM-USA.com

Contact Us At: support@ARAM-USA.com



Tuning and Troubleshooting

I have the kit working, however I found that some notes sound like a loud clacking noise instead of a note:

This is normal and we use different tuning methods to achieve a nice clear note on whatever resonator you attach

Software Tuning : (In the arduino IDE)

myActuator.setFrequencyTuning(MinFrequency, MaxFrequency, DampingAmount)

This dampens the actuator between MinFrequency and MaxFrequency by the percentage given in DampingAmount.

le:

if damping amount is 1 no sound is produced

If damping amount is 0, no damping occurs, actuator is loudest

Use this to dampen between frequencies where the actuator and resonator create a loud hitting noise instead of a musical note.

Physical Tuning : (Using objects to tune the actuator)

Option 1: Tuning With a Magnet

Placing a magnet opposite to the actuator above the plunger will change the force. You can change the resonances using such a method

The effect will depend on:

The size of the magnet

The strength of the magnet

The distance of the magnet to the actuator

You can change any of these variables to see what effect it has on the tuning of the actuator.

It is possible to achieve louder sounds through this method

Option 2: Adding a physical buffer

Adding a sheet, paper towel, tissue, or other soft barrier will decrease the "recoil" energy at resonant frequencies, although this will in turn reduce volume.



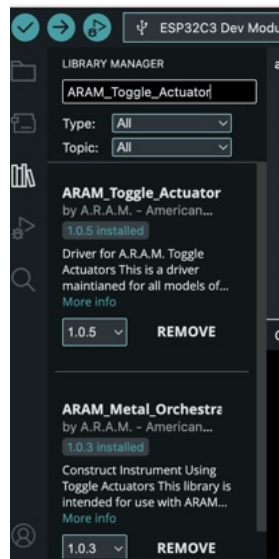
General Troubleshooting :

I'm having issues coding the esp32

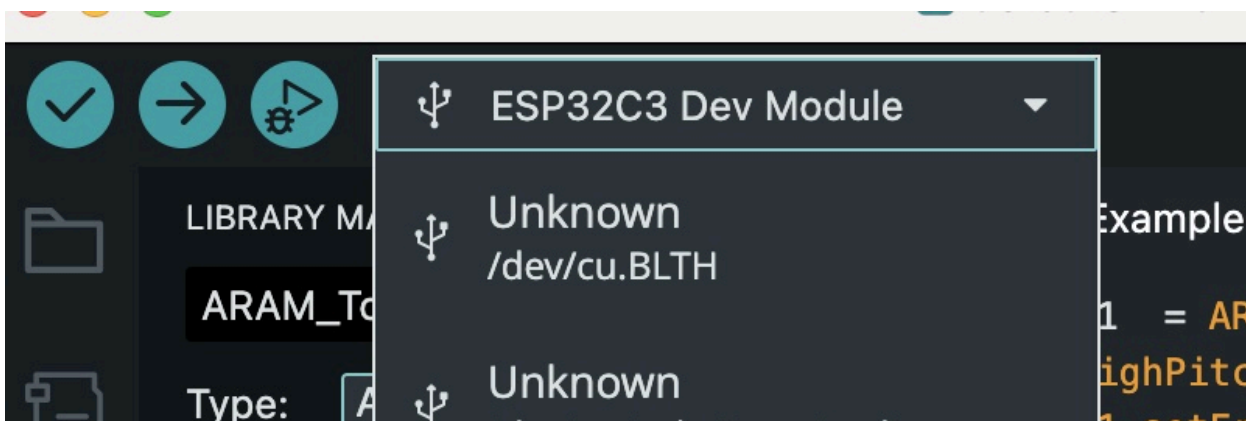
First let's make sure you have the right software, you'll need the **Arduino IDE**

<https://www.arduino.cc/en/software/>

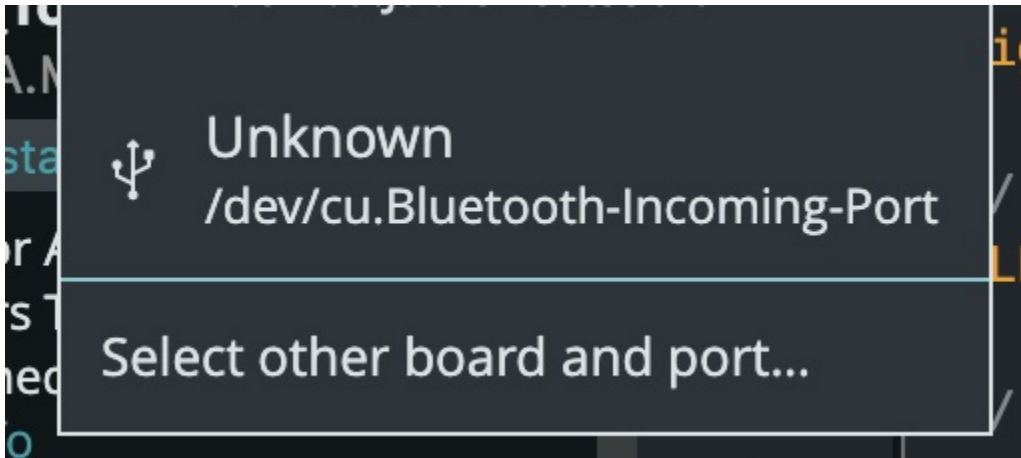
Next to use the actuator you'll need either the *ARAM_Toggle_Actuator* or the *ARAM_Metal_Orchestra* library. Search for either by name in the **Library Manager**



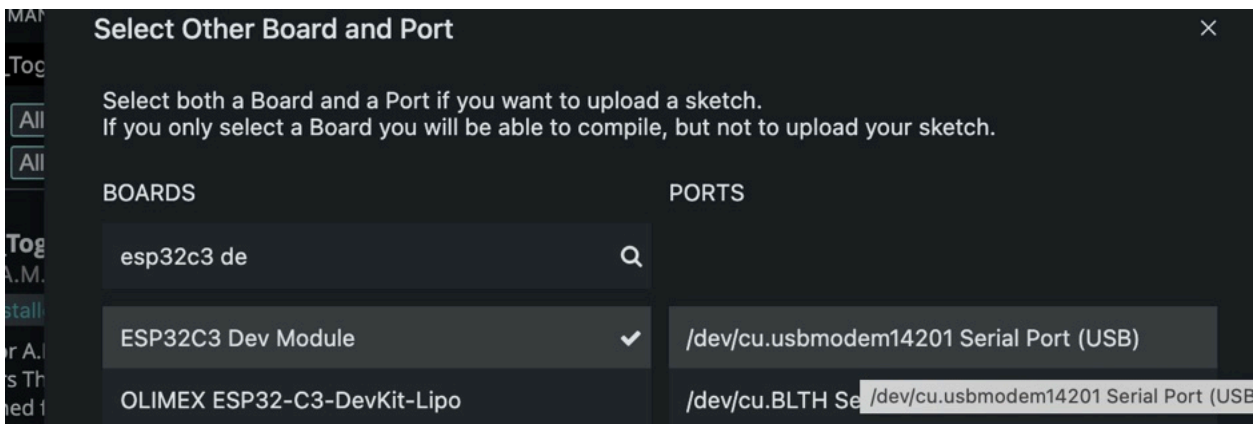
Next you'll need to import whichever library you downloaded into your program, see any of the above code examples, or click more info on either of the libraries to view code examples



Before uploading your code, ensure that the correct output is selected.



If you don't see *ESP32C3 Dev Module* appear automatically, select the "**Select other board and port...**"



Search and Select **ESP32C3 Dev Module** in the boards section
Select the **usb Serial Port** in the ports section



ARAM-MOTCA_0_10-0SP *Quick Start Guide*

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Sincerely:

Jack Serlin,

Founder of American Robotics Assisted Manufacturing

Contact Email:

Support@Aram-usa.com